

Strengths:

1. One of my biggest strengths during my “My Favorite Thing” speech was speaking clearly about my topic and sticking to my story through the presentation. My structure (**Professor B. 9/8/25**) felt good, and it kept the whole story moving nicely. I treated my speech as a timeline and started from the beginning of my sports journey, and tied everything back together by coming to the present.
2. Another strength was my passion for the topic, and this helped me create a cohesive speech with all of my ideas connected properly. I was able to avoid using filler words (**Professor B. 9/8/25**) such as “um” or “like”. This made my speech sound better, and it helped me appear more confident while in front of the class.
3. In addition, I also liked how I projected my voice and kept a consistent pace of speech (**Professor B. 9/8/25**). I have always been a “loud” speaker, which makes it easier for me to share my ideas without straining my voice or actively trying to speak louder. This allowed me to focus on my ideas and how I phrased them rather than my voice alone.

Weaknesses:

1. Even though there were certain parts of my speech that I was proud of, I also had some weaknesses that can be improved on. My first weakness was my lack of eye contact (**Professor B. 9/8/25**) with the left side of the audience. I tend to look in the direction of the audience, but not directly at them. For example, I was looking at the walls and the ground for some time while also scanning the room. Although I spoke well about the topic, this may have given a weird perception to the audience.
2. Another weakness of my speech was my lack of hand gestures or body movement. I could have used the room around me and presented some body language (**Professor B. 9/8/25**) to appear more confident and relax a bit while presenting.
3. My third weakness was how I ended my story, and my time management (**Professor B. 9/8/25**) while presenting. I had trouble ending my story smoothly. I had more to share, and I felt that I didn’t end my story very smoothly due to the time constraint, and that I didn’t know what to say that would be a good conclusion.

How To Improve:

1. For my next speech, I would plan what I would want to say more than I did the previous time. To work on my eye contact, I can practice presenting 3-5 times (**Professor B. 9/8/25**) to my family before I have to go present to the class. Also, although we didn’t use notes on this speech, I can work on knowing my topic without the need for notes so that I can focus more on making eye contact and engaging with the audience next time.
2. For my hand gestures, I want to be able to plan areas in my speech where I can use them effectively. If I do use hand gestures in my speeches, I want them to be meaningful to the story (**Professor B. 9/8/25**) and help the audience understand my point, rather than a nervous habit. I could once again rehearse my speech before I get to class and plan when I want to use hand gestures and how to time them correctly.

3. Finally, to practice my time management and end my story, I could once again practice my speech. But more specifically, I could practice with a timer (**Professor B. 9/8/25**). This way, I can plan my speech around the time constraints and add only my key ideas at first. Then, after seeing how much time I would have left, I can add to my speech to include some supporting details and information